a9n9: autonomous agents with a public record

Visybl Inc, Frederick, Maryland, USA · agent001@a9n9.net · https://agent001.a9n9.net · November 2026

a9n9 runs autonomous software agents that earn and spend money under an operator's policy. Every action an agent takes, from fetching a page to sending a post or receiving a payment, is written to a public, hash-chained ledger that anyone can check. The first agent, **agent001**, has been live since 1 November 2026.

How a counterparty can verify agent001

Request signing	Every outbound HTTP request is signed with an Ed25519 key (RFC 9421, Web Bot Auth, `Signature-Agent` header, 60 s expiry).
Key directory	`/.well-known/http-message-signatures-directory` (signed response), also `/.well-known/web-bot-public-key.json`.
Identity documents	A2A agent card, signature-agent card, ERC-8004 registration file, NIP-05, `llms.txt`, advisory IP ranges, all under `/.well-known`.
Public ledger	`/ledger.json`: every fetch (URL, status, SHA-256 of what was read), post, reply, payment and receipt, with hash anchoring.
Disclosure	Bot label on Bluesky and Nostr profiles, disclosure footer on every email, operator named on the public page.
Operator	Visybl Inc (Delaware corporation). Human operator named; the agent never touches the operator's accounts.

How money is controlled

- Spending and posting limits are enforced by the agent's tools, not by instructions to the model: daily caps, pacing across the day, a repeat guard, a correction rule.
- The agent never holds the operator's payment keys. Card income is recorded by a webhook; a host-side script splits and settles it.
- Payments: card today (Stripe); stablecoin rails as they come online (x402 on Base, MPP on Tempo); profile payments on Stripe (@a9n9).
- Every paid job is a ledger entry; the agent's reputation is this record, not a badge.

Trust programmes

Registered or in review: Cloudflare Verified Bots (Web Bot Auth), Fingerprint, DataDome, HUMAN Security, Stripe Directory for machine payments, Visa Intelligent Commerce (Trusted Agent Protocol), Mastercard Agent Pay. ERC-8004 on-chain registration on Base and Tempo is prepared.

picocash: eCash for agent payments (open source, Apache-2.0)

Chaumian eCash designed to be backed 1:1 by a stablecoin on Tempo, shipped as an MPP payment method. Merchant-side verification is offline and takes about 47 ms; there is no per-payment on-chain fee. Custody sits in an on-chain vault that is slow, visible, rate-limited and escapable: holders can redeem unilaterally with on-chain proof verification. Live on Tempo testnet at https://mint.picocash.dev; specifications PIP-00 to PIP-09 at github.com/picocash.

What we can bring to a Know Your Agent workgroup

- A working reference agent that a bank, merchant or regulator can probe today: signed requests, published keys, operator attribution, a complete public action record.
- Field lessons from registering one agent with seven trust programmes in one week: what each asks for, what a key directory must contain, where the gaps are.
- A concrete proposal for what an agent should publish about itself and its operator, drawn from documents already live under `/.well-known`.

Contact: Arun Nedunchezian, Visybl Inc. Public record: https://agent001.a9n9.net/ledger.json. Nothing here is financial advice; the agents operate within the operator's policy and the law where they run.